



Partners

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Goal

The team that gets all of their pieces “home” first wins. The game’s outcome is decided by the “partners” abilities to work together. The game requires that the players carefully consider each move.

Preparation

Set the playing board on the table. The players that are sitting across from each other are partners. In other words, gold and blue are a team and red and green are a team. Each player receives 4 playing pieces, to be placed beside the playing board. Shuffle the cards and give each player 4 cards.

How to Play

The players may look at their cards, but must keep them hidden from the other players. Each player must select 1 of his 4 cards to give to his partner. Partners trade cards with each other simultaneously and should keep the cards’ values hidden from their opponents. At the beginning of the game there are few tactics involved, but as the game progresses the cards selected to trade will become more significant.

The player to the left of the dealer starts by placing a card at the center of the playing board (this becomes the discard pile) and takes the action the card shows. The pieces move clockwise on the playing board. A player can only place a piece in the start area by playing a start card. If, on his turn, a player is unable to use any of his cards, he must discard all of his cards. The player must then wait until cards are dealt out again. (Note that the “byttekort” can be played without having any pieces in play.)

Special Cards



By using this card, a player can move one of his own pieces 4 spots backwards. This isn’t possible, however, for pieces that have gotten “home.” Those pieces are safe and can’t move out or be switched.



This card can be split up and used on two or more pieces. A player can, for example, move one of his pieces 5 spots, and another 2 spots.



When this card is played, the player is allowed to switch any two pieces that are in play (but not the pieces that are home or in the start area.) If the player doesn’t have any pieces in play, he can use it to help his partner or to inconvenience his opponents.



When this card is played, the player chooses whether to move his piece 1 or 14.

When any other card is played, the player simply moves one of his pieces the number of spots forward that is showed on the card.

When all of the players have played their 4 cards, the dealer deals 4 new cards to each player, and the game continues. After three rounds, the next player collects all of the cards from the discard pile, shuffles them, and deals them out. Play continues in this fashion until the game is finished. After every deal, each pair must trade 1 of their 4 cards with each other.

If a player has one of more of his pieces in his own start area, none of the other players’ pieces can move past that point, including his partner.

If you have a -4 card and a piece in you start area, it can be very advantageous to move that piece backwards and thus come very close to “home.”

If a player’s piece lands on a spot where one of the other three players’ pieces is already, then he will knock the other player’s piece out of the game, so that another start card must be played to start with it. If a player’s piece lands where there is two of one of the other players’ pieces, then his piece will be knocked out of the game.

When a player has two pieces on one spot, those pieces are safe, and can’t be switched.

When a piece is home, it is safe and can’t be switched.

Pieces that are home can’t move past each other. It is therefore necessary to use some cards to move pieces into place in the “home” area.

When a player is in a situation where he cannot use any of his cards, he must discard the rest of his cards and wait until the next deal.

Winning

The goal is to get all of your own pieces home, and help your partner. As soon as one player’s pieces are all home, he can help his partner by using his own cards to move his partner’s pieces. (They must still trade cards.)

The outcome of the game also depends on who is best at hindering their opponents.